GuildofStudents
University of Birmingham

Job Description

Job Title: Pub Manager

Responsible to: Business Development Manager/ Director of Engagement

Line manages: The Food & Beverage team through the Deputy Pub Manager & Kitchen Manager

Grade: Guild Grade F

Organisation:

The Venues team manages the Guild's Food & Beverage operations including, Joe's Bar (JD Wetherspoon pub), nightclub operations and event security within the Venues Department. The Venues Department is within the Engagement Directorate. The Engagement Directorate is one of four at the Guild, reporting to the CEO, alongside the Directorates of Operations, Finance & Systems and Community, Support & Representation.

Job Purpose:

The Pub Manager is a key role in leading, developing and supporting staff to deliver the Guild's strategic plan for students. Acting as a role model for the required standard of values, behaviour and performance, we expect managers to create an inclusive and engaging environment for all.

The Pub Manager is required:

- To be responsible for all aspects of managing the JD Wetherspoon (JDW) pub, on a day-to-day basis along with the Guild nightclub and licensed events.
- To be responsible for achieving all financial targets set by taking proactive steps to build sales and control costs.
- To be responsible for ensuring excellent customer service, adhering to all JDW and Guild standard operating procedures (SOPs).

This role will require a highly student and customer focused approach together with an emphasis on teamwork. The role involves extensive collaboration with internal and external stakeholders to ensure that staff and Officers are well-informed, prepared and supported to engage with students.

Success in the role will be built on good working relationships with stakeholders, acting as a strong, positive ambassador for the Guild and having a clear focus on taking action to ensure that under-represented groups can find a comfortable place here.

Generating a culture of ambitious targets and taking a strategic approach to the evaluation and development of the departments' work are key. People managers are expected to act as role models for the Guild's competency framework, which should be read in conjunction with this job description.

Key Role Responsibilities

1. To work with the Director of Engagement & Business Development Manager in all aspects of managing the JD Wetherspoons franchise (Joes Bar), along with the Guild nightclub and security in Guild Venues operations.

2. To achieve the following on a day-to-day basis, excellent customer service, serving food and drinks to the correct specification, maintaining a clean, safe and legal workplace within the venues operations, adhering to Wetherspoons standard operating procedures (SOPs) and Guild policies, meeting sales and profit targets.

3. To oversee, manage and guide the Venues team by leading by example, demonstrating how to complete tasks, motivating and coaching the team, development in line with the Guild's and JDW's policies and behavioural competency framework.

4. To deliver consistently high standards of cleanliness, quality, service, maintenance and atmosphere (CQSMA), proactively managing results which fall below expectations

5. To be welcoming to customers; maintain high levels of customer management on every shift

6. To adopt a stand-back-and-look (SBAL) approach to ensure that all areas are correctly presented throughout the day, ensuring that all POS meets current guidelines

7. To be aware of, and knowledgeable about, all promotions, events and new products in the pub, sharing your knowledge with the team to ensure that it has the latest information.

8. To take pride in maintaining the highest standards of cleanliness by adopting our clean-as-you-go philosophy for all areas. Ensure that all areas are cleaned and maintained, throughout the day, in accordance with guidelines, ensuring the team actions any points raised on kitchen checks in a timely manner.

9. To respond to any customer feedback in a positive and helpful manner, seeking support, if required, as well as reviewing all customer feedback with the Director of Engagement / Business Development Manager and identifying/actioning any training needs

10. To maintain office administration, in line with company policies and general data protection regulations (GDPR), including use of duty manager logbooks, CCTV, keys, safe and storage of paperwork

11. To take responsibility in achieving all financial targets set by taking proactive steps to build sales and control costs.

12. To work with the Director of Engagement / Business Development Manager to forecast sales and associated costs, review and manage all aspects of the profit and loss account and maximise sales opportunities.

13. To know local competitors and their current pricing/activities and the core customer base (Students, local businesses etc)

14. To manage stock holdings and minimise shrinkage, monitoring correct pouring and dispensing of products, completing daily line checks and logging all wastage, maintaining appropriate order levels and receiving deliveries, ensuring full availability of products at all times, investigating and reporting any anomalies, as required.

15. To take part in weekly blue-bag meetings and monthly business review meetings with the JDW area manager, agreeing on/actioning all targets set

16. To Make the working environment safe, legal and comfortable, by adhering to and enforcing:
    - standard operating procedures (SOPs).
    - age verification policy (including Challenge 21/25).
    - equality, diversity and inclusion (EDI) policy, including sexual harassment.
    - all legislation, including licensing law, trading standards and customs and excise regulations.
    - food safety policies, ensuring that five-star ratings are achieved or maintained.
    - know how to welcome and assist EHOs in the pub
    - health, safety and security procedures, including COSHH, daily fire checks and loss prevention.

17. To oversee the implementation of the delivery plans for the department through the staff team, and regularly review, evaluate and report on their overall effectiveness in supporting students and customers. This includes preparing reports, utilising data and other relevant information for University/Guild committees, as requested.

18. To monitor the management accounts on a regular basis, and prepare, manage and report on the departmental budget as required in accordance with the Guild's financial procedures manual.

19. To actively look for ways to work smarter and identify service and process improvements, through research and evidence, and to recommend these to the Director of Engagement / Business Development Manager for consideration.

20. To affiliate to relevant bodies and establish a network of partnerships and contacts at local, regional and national levels, as necessary to improve and develop the services and to facilitate learning and development activities where helpful for the Guild's work.

General Duties

1. To undertake appropriate induction, ongoing training and personal development as required for the role.

2. To adhere to all Guild policy with reference to HR, staffing, health and safety, data protection, environmental impact and any other specific Guild Policy which impacts upon your role or that of the team/department.

3. To be familiar with the Guild's competency framework, striving always to demonstrate the positive behaviours which drive the highest standards of personal and organisational performance in supporting our students. People managers should aim to act in line with level 2 (manager) of the six competencies (Student and Customer Focus, Accountability, Results Focus, Inclusivity, Communication and Teamwork) and with level 1 of the 'Motivational Leadership' competency, which is designed to support staff to achieve high performance.

4. To act as a role model in portraying a positive image of the Guild both internally and externally, acting as an ambassador and displaying high standards of personal integrity and professionalism.

5. To participate as an active and accountable member of the Guild's wider management team.

6. To support the wider work of the Department and Guild, where necessary, in the event of sickness, holiday or other exceptional circumstances. This includes being available to assist with events and incidents that may occur out of normal working hours.

7. To undertake such other duties as may be reasonably required, consistent with the nature and grade of the post.

February 2026

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PERSON SPECIFICATION: Pub Manager

	Essential	Desirable
EDUCATION, QUALIFICATIONS AND TRAINING		
Good general education, typically to degree standard, including Maths and English at least to GCSE or equivalent	✓	
Have a Personal Licence qualification	✓	
Food Safety Level 3	✓	
SIA CCTV Licence		✓
IOSH Managing Safely Qualification		✓
A Management/Leadership or related professional qualification such as the JDW advanced management academy		✓
EXPERIENCE		
Experience of successfully managing a staff team to achieve service and quality standards		✓
Experience of developing and managing budgets effectively	✓	
Experience of developing and maintaining complex relationships with internal and external stakeholders	✓	
Experience of working in a democratic environment with complex decision-making structures		✓
Experience of strategically evaluating and developing services and systems		✓
Experience of working effectively with others on cross-organisational projects and issues		✓
SKILLS AND KNOWLEDGE		
Ability to complete all aspects of the pub manager appointment plan	✓	
Attendance and participation in regular team meetings, manager meetings and training sessions	✓	
Ability to use standard office software including digital systems	✓	
Strong communicator - able to present complex information clearly and concisely in writing and verbally	✓	
Ability to take a collaborative approach to solving problems	✓	
Ability to generate and share ideas for improvements in the food & beverage operation	✓	
Ability to maintain financial records and control budgets	✓	
Ability to recruit, motivate and develop others, supporting and training new and progressing team members	✓	

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Ability to support the achievement of the departmental action plan.	✓	
Ability to work using own initiative	✓	
Ability to encourage excellence and support a learning and development culture	✓	
PERSONAL QUALITIES/BEHAVIOURS		
Highly motivated by working in a student-led, democratic workplace	✓	
Inclusivity: Celebrates and supports equality and diversity and acts as a role model in creating a welcoming and inclusive environment	✓	
Student and Customer Focus: Proactive in empowering students and improving services and opportunities	✓	
Teamwork: Open and approachable – proactively builds good relationships with people across the Guild	✓	
Accountability: Role models, supports and facilitates the team to work more efficiently and do things differently	✓	
Accountability: Attention to detail	✓	
Results Focus: Highly resilient – can maintain personal direction and motivation and support colleagues in difficult situations	✓	
Results Focus: Generates and supports an ambitious, high-quality, results-driven culture	✓	
Motivational Leadership: Actively supports people - creates a positive environment for the team and shows appropriate care, empathy and concern for others	✓	
Communication: Is able to present a case confidently and persuasively, and address sensitive issues appropriately	✓	